

CHAPTER 11

BACK IN COURT

'Do you have any complaints?'

9 December 1994. Around 10.30 am I was asked to get ready to be taken to the court of the additional Chief Judicial Magistrate in Trivandrum. While getting into the police van at Pallipuram camp I saw Kurein E Kalathil, a friend of mine.

I waved at him. Kurien looked tense, hesitated for a moment, and waved back. He obviously did not want anyone to see him wave at me. Later, I came to know that Kurien was called to be questioned about his connection with me.

Kurien was introduced to me by Vijayan, a common friend. Later my son found a job in Kurien's office as a computer programmer.

After Sasi's arrest, Kurien used to call me, asking what it was all about. I would tell him that it appeared to be a case of mistaken facts, that the idea of selling rocket technology through papers was laughable. When I was arrested, Kurien might have been shocked. And when the CBI officers landed at his office, he must have been paranoid. This explained why he was hesitant to wave back at me as I was leaving for the additional Chief Judicial Magistrate that morning.

In the police van I found the two Maldivian women, Mariam Rasheeda and Fauziyya Hassan. It was the first time I was seeing them. I felt overwhelmed by anger and hatred towards these women, for the IB men had told me that they had confessed to having taken the rocket drawings from me. It was only much later that I realised that the women, innocents themselves, were tortured